

CHLOROCRESOL

_____Name

_____Date

also called... **4-chloro-3-cresol**, **4-chloro-3-methylphenol**, **parachloro-m-cresol**, or **PCMC**. Sensitized persons *often also react to closely related chloroxylenol*, also known as 4-chloro-3,5-xyleneol, 4-chloro-3,5-dimethylphenol, para-chloro-meta-xyleneol, or PCMX.

What is it?

Chlorocresol is active against bacteria, and is used as an antiseptic or a preservative, especially for industrial uses.

Where might it be found?

Hand cleaner
Shampoo
Baby powder
Talcum powder
Foot powder
Athlete's foot cream
Foot moisturizer
Topical antiseptic
Carbolated petroleum jelly
Barrier cream
Adhesives, glues
Electrode paste, EKG gel
Inks
Paints, varnishes
Textile finishes
Packing materials
Tanning agents
Cutting oils
Metalworking coolants
Veterinary pesticides
Veterinary fungicides
Embalming fluid

Several prescription creams, including most forms of alclometasone dipropionate, betamethasone dipropionate, betamethasone valerate, clobetasol propionate, and gentamicin

Rarely used as a preservative in injectable medicines

How to avoid it:

Avoid using any product that contains **chlorocresol** or **chloroxylenol**. Look at the complete ingredient list on the label of each product you use for any of the names above. If this agent is present, one of its names should appear in the ingredients. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package.

Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

For possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of each product you encounter there, looking for any of the names highlighted above. Your safety officer may help identify products that contain it. Sometimes it is necessary to contact the manufacturer of a product to learn if this agent is present in it.

Tell your doctor about this allergy. Show your physician the list at the left. Check to be sure chlorocresol is not an ingredient in any of your prescribed or injected medications.